

University of North Texas at Dallas

Fall 2025

SYLLABUS

COMM 1010.0004 Introduction to Communication 3 HRS

Department of		Communication and Digital Media
Instructor Name:		Jennifer E. Sanmiguel
Office Location:		In-Person: FH302A Virtual By Appointment: Microsoft Teams
Email Address:		Jennifer.Sanmiguel@untDallas.edu
Office Hours:		In-Person and Microsoft Teams MTW 1:30 – 2:30; and by appointment
Course Format/Structure:		100% Face to Face only.
Classroom Location:		FH 212
Class Meeting Days & Times:		T & TH 11:30 am – 12:50 pm
Course Catalog Description:		Examination of how communication principles and skills influence our understanding of current social issues such as global climate crisis, health care, human rights, diversity, and poverty. Focus on practical applications and community engagement includes experimental learning with community partners. Oral communication skills and collaborative group building skills are emphasized. Satisfies a portion of the Understanding the Human Community requirement of the University Core Curriculum.
Pre-/Co-requisites:		None.
Required Text:		• Edwards, A., Edwards, C., Wahl, S. T., & Myers, S. A. (2024). The communication age: Connecting and engaging, (4th ed.). Thousand Oaks, CA: Sage. (ISBN: 9781071824535) • Access to a computer with Microsoft Word and PowerPoint, Microsoft Teams, Adobe Flash, Social Media phone applications, and a printer • Notecards for delivering oral presentations.
Recommended Text and References:		• Additional readings and materials may be supplied in class or posted to Canvas. • American Psychological Association. (2021). <i>Publication manual of the American Psychological Association</i>, (7th ed.). Washington, D.C.: American Psychological Association. (ISBN: 978-0-357-63296-3) • OWL Purdue Online Writing Lab at http://owl.english.purdue.edu/owl/resource/560/1/
Access to Learning Resources:		UNT Dallas Library: (Founders Hall) phone: (972) 338-1616 web: http://www.untDallas.edu/library e-mail: Library@untDallas.edu UNT Dallas Bookstore: (Building 1) phone: (972) 780-3652 web: http://www.untDallas.edu/bookstore e-mail: untDallas@bkstr.com
Canvas Resources Supported Browsers: • Chrome 67 & 68 • Firefox 60 & 61 • Flash 29, 30 (for audio/video) • Respondus Lockdown Browser • Safari 10, 11 Supported Devices: • iPhone • Android • Chromebook <i>Note: Tablet users can use the Canvas app</i> Screen Readers: • VoiceOver (Safari) • JAWS (Internet Explorer) • NVDA (Firefox) <i>Note: There is no screen reader support for Canvas in Chrome</i>		Getting Help with Canvas Canvas 24/7 Phone Support for Students: 1-833-668-8634 Canvas Help Resources: • Canvas Student Guide – https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10701 • For additional assistance, contact Student Assistance (UNT Dallas Distance Learning): DAL 1, Rm 157 phone: (972)338-5580 email: distancelearning@untDallas.edu <i>If you are working with Canvas 24/7 Support to resolve a technical issue, make sure to keep me updated on the troubleshooting progress.</i> <i>If you have a course-related issue (course content, assignment troubles, quiz difficulties) please contact me during office hours or by email.</i>

Course Goals or Overview: The goals of this course are as follows -	
1	To increase familiarity with the fundamental principles of various forms of communication.
2	To increase understanding of a variety of concepts central to the study of communication.
3	To teach students how to identify the structures, functions, and dynamics of various forms of communication.
4	To exercise creative, critical, and analytical thinking and evaluation skills in simulations, exercises and case studies of communication.
5	To build awareness of the diversity of participants in communicative processes and relationship of diversity to the processes and outcomes of communication

Learning Objectives/Outcomes: At the end of this course, students will be able to:	
1	Apply the principles of human communication including: perception, verbal communication, nonverbal communication, listening, and audience analysis.
2	Demonstrate how to establish and maintain relationships through the use of interpersonal communication.
3	Apply small group communication skills including: problem solving, group roles, leadership styles, and cohesiveness.
4	Recognize how to communicate within diverse environments.
5	Develop, research, organize, and deliver formal public speeches.

Course Outline

This schedule is subject to change by the instructor. Any changes to this schedule will be communicated in class or via class email or Canvas announcement. Additional readings and activities may be added, these will be noted in the Readings and Exercises/Assignments sections

Dates	Course Content	Assignments/Readings Due
Week 1		
Tuesday, 8/26	Course introduction Introductory Activity Set ground rules and guidelines Why study Communication? – Rhetorical Foundations	
Thursday, 8/28	Communication in the 21st Century Types; Models; Contexts Community Building <i>Discuss Personal Artifact Presentation – if time allows</i>	Ch. 1

Week 2 – Syllabus Quiz & Welcome Survey due Sunday, 9/7, 11:59 pm

Tuesday, 9/2	Perception, Self, and Communication Self-Concept; Others; Identity; Perception Personal Artifact Presentation Example	Ch. 2 Micro Current Events Assigned
Thursday, 9/4	Verbal Communication Nature; Power; Culture; Trouble with Language	Ch. 3 Syllabus Contract

Week 3 – Personal Artifact Presentation Full-Sentence Outlines due Sunday, 9/14, at 11:59 pm

Tuesday, 9/9	Nonverbal Communication Characteristics; Functions; Influences	Ch. 4
Thursday, 9/11	<i>Workshop Personal Artifact Presentation</i>	Quiz #1 Due 9/14 at 11:59 pm

Week 4

Tuesday, 9/16	Listening Types of Listening; Challenges; Strategies; Skills	Ch. 5
Thursday, 9/18	Communication, Culture, and Diversity Change; Diversity; Mindfulness; Power; Intersectionality; Marginalization <i>Workshop Personal Artifact Presentation – If time allows</i>	Ch. 6

Week 5

Tuesday, 9/23	Personal Artifact Presentations	
Thursday, 9/25	Personal Artifact Presentations	

Week 6

Tuesday, 9/30	Researching Your Presentation Source Citation and Credibility	Ch. 11 PIP Groups Made
Thursday, 10/2	Researching Your Presentation Using Library Research Resources	Ch. 11

Week 7 – Informative Presentation Annotated Bibliography due Sunday, 10/12, at 11:59 pm

Tuesday, 10/7	Selecting Your Topic and Knowing Your Audience Purpose; Topics; Audience Analysis	Ch. 11
Thursday, 10/9	Organizing Your Presentation Beginning and Ending; Organizing Ideas; Supporting Materials	Ch. 12 Quiz #2 or Exam #1 due Sunday, 10/12 , at 11:59 pm

Week 8 – Informative Presentation Full-Sentence Outline due Sunday, 10/19, at 11:59 pm

Tuesday, 10/14	Delivering Your Presentations Delivery; Reducing Speaking Anxiety Working with PowerPoint	Ch. 13
Thursday, 10/16	Informative Presentations Types; Techniques; Characteristics	Ch. 14

Week 9 – Informative Presentation PowerPoint due Sunday, 10/26, at 11:59 pm

Tuesday, 10/21	Small Group and Team Communication Goals; Development; Leadership and Power; Decision Making, Problem-Solving	Ch. 8
Thursday, 10/23	Workplace and Organizational Communication Culture; Socialization; Dissent	Ch. 9 Quiz #3 due Sunday, 10/26 , at 11:59 pm

Week 10 – Informative Presentation Video due Sunday, 11/2, at 11:59 pm

Tuesday, 10/28	Interpersonal Conflict Communication Forming Relationships; Relational Culture and Climate	Ch. 7
Thursday, 10/30	Jung's Typology/Myers-Briggs Type Indicator Small group class activity <i>Workshop Informative Presentation</i>	<i>SGPP Groups Made</i>

Week 11

Tuesday, 11/4	Communication and New Media Traditions; New Media Theory; Identity; Community	Ch. 10 Identity Via Media
Thursday, 11/6	Communication and New Media Presenting your online Identity	Ch. 10

Week 12 – Identity Via Media due Sunday, 11/16 , at 11:59 pm

Tuesday, 11/11	Persuasive Presentations Persuasion; Persuasive Goals; Logical Fallacies	Ch. 15
Thursday, 11/13	<i>Identity Via Media & Persuasive Presentation Workshop</i>	Quiz #4 or Exam #2 due Sunday, 11/16, at 11:59pm

Week 13 – Persuasive Presentation Annotated Bibliography due Sunday, 11/23, at 11:59 pm

Tuesday, 11/18	Using the Socratic Method <i>Using the Socratic Method</i> <i>Workshop Persuasive Presentations</i>	
Thursday, 11/20	<i>Workshop Persuasive Presentations</i>	

Week 14 – Persuasive Presentation Full-Sentence Outline due Sunday, 11/30, at 11:59 pm

Tuesday, 11/25	No Class	
11/27 – 11/28	Fall Break	No Classes

Week 15

Tuesday, 12/2	Group Persuasive Presentations	Group Persuasive Presentations PowerPoint due day of Presentation
Thursday, 12/4	Group Persuasive Presentations	Group Persuasive Presentations PowerPoint due day of Presentation

Week 16 – Self-Analysis paper due Wednesday, 12/10, at 11:59 pm

Thursday, 12/11	Oral Presentations of Self-Analysis Paper	11:00 am – 1:00 pm
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Course Evaluation Methods

This course will utilize the following instruments to determine student grades and proficiency of the learning outcomes for the course.

1. **Participation and In-Class Exercises (150 points):** In-class exercises will occur daily and CANNOT be made up, even if you have an excused absence. You must be in class on the day we complete exercises. Failure to appear in class will result in a participation grade of 0 for the day.
2. **Micro Current Event Presentations (20 points):** Students will select a day within the course calendar to present. This presentation will consist of presenting an article or event that is currently happening in the world. Students will not have to present until the day they have signed up for, if missed then they have one chance to reschedule. If missed a second time, students will receive a zero for a grade. The presentation should take no more than 2-3 minutes and can mention at least one or more concepts learned from the class. These articles can be from pop culture, sports, music, current events, etc. We need to be aware of what is happening in the world around us. With social media being a rapid form of communication, we can constantly be in tune with the world around us. This allows us to learn what is currently happening in different facets of the world. This assignment is open from the second week of class up to the week before finals. Students **MUST** present to receive the points and credit for this assignment.
3. **Syllabus Quiz (15 points):** There will be a syllabus quiz due on Canvas on the second week of the course. This quiz will cover material that is all within the course syllabus.
4. **Quizzes (160 points):** There will 4 quizzes in the course (40 points each) or 2 exams (80 points). Quizzes and exams will be available through Canvas from the first day of class and close at 11:59 pm on the final day of class. This allows you to take each quiz/exam at your leisure, but take note of the due dates to keep you on a manageable schedule. Each quiz/exam will cover only the assigned chapters of the text and may include multiple choice and true/false questions to probe your understanding of the main points of the reading. Quizzes are not cumulative. To prepare for quizzes/exams, keep up with your readings and regularly review notes. Because of the extensive time allowed to take quizzes/exam, there are no make-up quizzes/exams.

Quiz #1	Ch. 1 – 4	Due: 09/14
Quiz #2	Ch. 5, 6, 11, & 12	Due: 10/12
Quiz #3	Ch. 13, 14, 8, & 9	Due: 10/26
Quiz #4	Ch. 7, 10, & 15	Due: 11/16

Or

Exam #1

Ch. 1 – 6, 11, & 12

Due: 10/12

Exam #2

Ch. 7 – 9, 10, & 13 – 15

Due: 11/16

5. **Presentations (615 points):** You will complete three extemporaneous speaking assignments, including formal and speaking outlines, and one informal speaking assignment that is tied to the course final. Specific criteria for each assignment will be detailed on Canvas.

Personal Artifact Presentation	2 - 4 minutes	100 Points	Due: 9/23 & 9/25
Partnered Informative Presentation	5 - 7 minutes	215 points	Due: 11/2
Small Group Persuasive Presentation	8 - 10 minutes	250 points	Due: 12/2 & 12/4
Self-Analysis	2 - 4 minutes	50 points	Due: 12/11

- **Personal Artifact Presentation (100 points):** The goal of this presentation is to share with the class about yourself in two ways: 1) provide an overview of yourself and the highlights of your life, and 2) show and describe an artifact that communicates who you are. You will receive full credit for delivering this presentation due to the personal nature of the assignment. This is an opportunity to deliver a 2-3-minute presentation without the pressure of being evaluated.
 - **Presentation Delivery (75 points):** Due to the personal nature of this presentation, students will receive full credit for giving this presentation.
 - **Full-Sentence Outlines (25 points):** A graded full-sentence outline must be turned in for each formal presentation. I do not accept late written work. Outlines not submitted by the scheduled deadline will be considered late.
 - Full-sentence outlines of each of your presentations must be submitted on Canvas by the end of the day on the date assigned in the course calendar. Credit will not be given if the full-sentence outline consists of keywords and phrases only. Ideas must be fully developed and sources cited correctly (when required). Each point should have at least two supporting points or none at all. For the informative presentation, a reference page **MUST** be included. Please carefully **PROOFREAD** your outlines before you submit them. Points will be deducted for grammatical, spelling, punctuation, and word choice errors. If your outline does not meet college-level standards, no credit will be given.
- **Partnered Informative Presentation (215 total points):** The goal of this presentation is working, in pairs, to inform your class about a social issue. Using supporting materials, such as scholarly research and popular culture media texts. You may select one or more media clips and each group member will provide information over the social issue your group has picked, the background and history over the social issue, why it is important, and how it affects our everyday lives. You and your group also will connect existing research to your concept to facilitate class learning.

Due to how prevalent we use virtual spaces in our everyday lives, this presentation is to be recorded and submitted to Canvas as a video. Students are to record themselves presenting their informative presentation on Zoom, Microsoft Teams, the Speaking Center, etc. Imagine this is a video essay over their chosen topics. Students are allowed to be creative with their videos, however they will be graded over their knowledge of their chosen topics, not their editing skills. This is a graded presentation requiring the submission of a full-sentence outline, as well as a use of PowerPoint as a presentation aid. Remember this is an informative presentation, not a persuasive one; your groups aim is to inform your audience about your chosen social issue.

 - **Group Presentation Delivery (75 points):** The group will be graded as a whole on the preparation and performance.
 - **Individual Presentation Delivery (50 points):** along with a group grade, students will be graded for the individual portion of their presentation.
 - **Annotated Bibliography (30 points):** The goal of this assignment is for students to summarize a minimum total of 2 scholarly sources, 1 source per person, for their informative presentation.
 - **Full-Sentence Outlines (25 points):** A graded full-sentence outline must be turned in for each formal presentation. I do not accept late written work. Outlines not submitted by the scheduled deadline will be considered late.

- **PowerPoint (20 points):** You will submit your PowerPoint through Canvas the night before your presentation is due. Make sure you review the PowerPoint Guidelines on Canvas and look at the examples to see how to cite your sources correctly. Follow the 1X6X6 rule – no more than 1 main idea per slide, 6 words per line, 6 lines on a slide. PROOFREAD YOUR WORK.
 - **Peer evaluation (15 points):** Students will identify their responsibilities on the presentation assignments and will be evaluated by their partner(s) at the end of the presentation.
- **Small Group Persuasive Presentation (250 points):** The goal of this presentation is to work in a group of 4, to change your audience's opinions or behaviors about a social issue by using logical and emotional appeals over said social issue that you and your group are passionate about. You will be divided into groups and your group will select a social issue and seek to persuade your audience with the effective use of ethos, pathos, and logos. You will be using supporting materials, such as scholarly research and popular culture media texts to support your arguments. You may select one or more media clips and each partner will provide information over the social issue, why it is important to advocate for it, and what we can do to help. You and your peers also will connect existing research to your concept to facilitate class learning. This is a graded presentation, requiring the submission of both formal and speaking outlines, as well as use of PowerPoint as a presentation aid. The following are the graded components to this assignment:
- **Full-Sentence Outlines (25 points):** A graded full-sentence outline must be turned in for each formal presentation. I do not accept late written work. Outlines not submitted by the scheduled deadline will be considered late.
 - **Annotated Bibliographies (30 points):** The goal of this assignment is for students to summarize scholarly work for their persuasive presentations. 4 scholarly sources minimum, 1 per team member.
 - **PowerPoint (20 points):** You will submit your PowerPoint through Canvas the night before your presentation is due. Make sure you review the PowerPoint Guidelines on Canvas and look at the examples to see how to cite your sources correctly. Follow the 1X6X6 rule – no more than 1 main idea per slide, 6 words per line, 6 lines on a slide. PROOFREAD YOUR WORK.
 - **Group Presentation Delivery (90 points):** The group will be graded as a whole on the preparation and performance.
 - **Individual Presentation Delivery (70 points):** along with a group grade, students will be graded for the individual portion of their presentation.
 - **Peer evaluation (15 points):** Students will identify their responsibilities on the presentation assignments and will be evaluated by their partner(s) at the end of the presentation.
- **Self-Analysis (50 points):** The final paper and presentation for the course will reflect on what you have learned from the course materials and experience of working with the content from this course. You will share briefly in a two-minute impromptu discussion at the final class meeting about your reflections. Failure to submit the assignment or appear at the final exam class meeting to present your paper will result in a ZERO for this assignment.
- **Identity Via Media (20 points):** In week 11 of the semester, students will cover Chapter 12: Communication and New Media. In this chapter, we learn about the various ways we present our identity through online spaces, the theories behind new media, and the community we create online. For this extra credit assignment, students can get into small groups of 2 – 3 and create a video over the different identities one displays online versus in their day-to-day life. Students can take several approaches to this assignment, but it **MUST** cover one's own online and in-person identity. This is a creative assignment that will be graded holistically due to the multitude of approaches that students can take with this assignment. What I will be looking for in the assignment are:
- **Communication Concepts**
 - Must cover identity and communication that we have covered in the course. This can include roles, culture, everyday life performance, communication styles, and many more.
 - **Critical Thinking**
 - How does your identity in person compare, contrast, or is a fragment of who you are online? Explore this and how mass media has played a part in your identity.

- **Creativity**

- Feel free to express yourself with this assignment. Make it unique to yourself and have fun! You can use current trends on YouTube or make something completely new.

- **Speaking Center Critique (20 points):** You will be required to schedule a minimum of one visit to the Speaking Center (Student Center Room #2044) to deliver and receive critique on one of your presentations. This may be either your informative or your persuasive presentations. N.B. If you and your informative presentation partner choose to visit the Speaking Center for your informative presentation, this does not exempt you from visiting for the persuasive presentation should your group members choose to practice the group presentation in the lab. You absolutely may visit both times.
The more practice you have, the better your presentations will be overall! Remember, **all COMM 1010 students are required to deliver and record ONE speech in the Speaking Lab.**

6. Extra Credit Opportunities: Extra credit opportunities may be announced at some point in the semester and are NOT guaranteed. Any opportunity will be announced well in advance. Extra credit is given at the discretion of the instructor and may include, but is not limited to:

- Class Exercises and guest speakers attending class.
- **Informative Video Essay (30 points):** We live in a highly technological age of communication where we often are able to speak to one another through a medium using technology. After the pandemic, virtual video streaming is a remote form of connecting and presenting a wide variety of content. For this extra credit assignment, students will work individually and record themselves delivering an informative presentation of their choice through Microsoft Teams or Zoom. The video must be 5 – 8 minutes in length. A PowerPoint or a visual component is required. Speak with instructor before submitting this assignment to gain approval of presentation topic. You **MUST** speak with the professor before hand before submission, assignment will be a **ZERO** if you do not meet with professor.
- Watch Randy Pausch's Last Lecture: Achieving Your Childhood Dreams on YouTube at http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ji5_MqicxSo and write a 3-5 page typed reflection paper (**maximum 30 points**).

PLEASE NOTE: Receiving extra credit means you do **EXTRA** work. If you fail to complete any assignment in the course, **YOU WILL LOSE ALL EXTRA CREDIT**. Evaluation is based upon the quality of work submitted. Simply submitting a completed assignment does not guarantee you will receive extra credit. You should apply the same effort on written extra credit work as you would on regular graded assignments.

Grading Matrix:

Each of the following assignments will be detailed thoroughly on Canvas. Be sure to access Canvas frequently for assignment guidelines and other important class documents.

Participation and In-Class Exercises	150 points
Syllabus Quiz	15 points
Micro Current Events	20 points
Quizzes	160 points
Speaking Center Critique	20 points
Personal Artifact Presentation	100 points
Presentation Delivery (75 points)	
Full-Sentence Outline (25 points)	
Partnered Informative Presentation	215 points
Annotated Bibliography (30 points)	
Full-Sentence Outline (25 points)	
Individual Portion of Presentation (50 points)	
Group Delivery of Presentation (75 points)	
PowerPoint (20 Points)	

Peer Evaluation (15 points)	
Identity Via Media	20 points
Small Group Persuasive Presentation	250 points
Annotated Bibliography (30 points)	
Full-Sentence Outline (25 points)	
Individual Delivery of Presentation (70 points)	
Group Delivery of Presentation (90 points)	
PowerPoint (20 points)	
Peer Evaluation (15 points)	
Self-Analysis Paper and Presentation	50 points
Total	1000 points

Your final grade is based on a total out of 1000 points.

900-1000 = A 800-899 = B 700-799 = C 600-699 = D 599 ↓ = F

Class Policies and Expectations

Active Learning

You are expected to take an active role in learning. If you are having trouble, come and see me – I will be glad to help. If there are things you do not understand, raise questions in class, as others may benefit from your inquiry. If you are hesitant to speak up in class, stop by after class or send me an email. I am here to assist in your learning, so do not hesitate if you need clarification or assistance.

Mobile Technology Policy

Although there may be opportunities to use mobile technology in class, please make sure your use of mobile technology is relevant to the class. If you find yourself tempted to use your technology for completing homework for other classes, surfing the Internet, or “playing” on social media, please **TURN IT OFF AND PUT IT AWAY**. It is disrespectful and distracts from community-building to use digital devices in class for any purpose other than class learning. If your digital device sounds off (rings, chirps, vibrates) in class, or if you are caught (by me or one of your peers) text messaging, surfing the internet, watching videos, or listening to music through headphones, earbuds, or airpods or simply wearing them, you will receive a warning. If caught or asked a second time, you will be asked to leave the class and will lose attendance and participation points for the day.

Missing Class

To help you get information about any class that you miss, you can use the ‘buddy system.’ Choose two classmates as your buddies. Exchange contact information so that if you are absent, you can contact one or both of your buddies for notes, assignments, and announcements.

Buddy Name: _____

Buddy Name: _____

Email: _____

Email: _____

Phone: _____

Phone: _____

Social Media Policy

Although I do maintain a broad social media presence, including multiple blogs, Facebook, Twitter, LinkedIn, Tumblr, Pinterest, Snapchat, Instagram, etc., if you use one of these platforms to contact me, I may not notice, and I definitely will not respond. Please note: I do not send or accept friend requests of current students through social media. If there is something you would like to share with me, either share it through the class discussion boards on Canvas or in class during our next meeting.

Microsoft Teams Etiquette

Everyone in this class will be put in a Microsoft Teams chat to help with direct communication with your peers and myself over course content. Office hours will be held in the Microsoft Teams course chat as well. When participating during my office hours, feel free to use the chat function, the raising hand function, turning on the webcam, or the microphone function to speak.

Plagiarism

Students need to do original work and properly cite all sources. For example, be aware of plagiarism—directly copying more than 3 or 4 words from another author without quoting (not just citing) the author is plagiarism. Cheating, plagiarizing, falsification, misrepresentation, or any other form of dishonesty will be dealt with severely. Students will be subjected to disciplinary action under college regulations.

Ethics and Integrity

Students are expected to complete their own original work, including but not limited to assigned work in class or at home, examinations, and research-based projects. It is academic dishonesty to use the ideas, data, or language of another without specific or proper acknowledgement. If you use ideas of others, regardless of who those individuals are (experts in their field, websites, friends from class, etc.), you must provide proper citation. Cheating, plagiarizing, fabrication of information or citations, facilitating acts of dishonesty by others, having unauthorized possession of examinations, submitting work of another person or work previously used without informing the instructor, tampering with the academic work of other students, use of Artificial Intelligence software to complete your work (unless explicitly permitted), or any other form of dishonesty will be dealt with severely. Students will be subjected to disciplinary action under university regulations.

Citizenship

This is a communication course and the very nature of the makeup of our community speaks to cultural differences. Naturally, respectful language is at the core of a course such as this. Please be mindful of the language and terms you use when speaking and writing. Communication shapes the way in which we see the world and the words we use matter. Each of us is responsible for creating a positive learning environment. Respectful class participation includes contributing ideas that relate to the topic, asking questions to clarify understanding, responding thoughtfully when called upon, and giving respectful attention to the instructor and classmates. Good communication skills include listening carefully to different opinions, analyzing what is said, clearly stating opinions without personal put-downs, encouraging classmates, synthesizing new information, and applying it. Disrespectful communication includes interrupting or attacking others, monopolizing the conversation, carrying on side conversations, and using personal technology for purposes other than classroom activity. A positive classroom environment improves learning for both the individual student and for the class as a whole.

E-mail Etiquette

When students send an email to their course instructor or course director, they must include a greeting, (“Good evening,” “Good morning,” Hello,” etc.), their name, the course they are enrolled in, their section number, a clear message, and a closing. The course section and a clear topic of the email must be included within the topic line. Additionally, students should activate and use their UNT email to contact their instructor. This policy is set in place to help students develop better communication and writing skills in a professional context. Please allow a full business day, 24 hours, from when the email was sent for a reply. Emails sent on Friday or over the weekend will be responded to within 42 hours. The course instructor will respond back as quickly as possible and to the best of their ability. Feel free to talk to the course instructor over the course material or for more in-depth questions during office hours. Please note that Canvas or Microsoft Teams messages are not reliable means of communication. If you have an immediate issue, concern, or question, please email the professor instead of a Canvas/Microsoft Teams message. Messages sent through these platforms may take longer to respond to than emails.

Presentation Policies

No profanity or content of a graphic nature. No children, animals, weapons, fire, grease (cooking) or dangerous objects. Any props you choose to use MUST be pre-approved by the instructor. Any prop used that has not been pre-approved will automatically reduce your grade for the presentation. All presentation topics must also be approved. Please be considerate and sensitive when choosing presentation topics. Please also be sensitive to the topic choices of others. It is important that this be a SAFE environment for everyone. Dress appropriately and professionally for each of your presentations. Do not interrupt your peers’ presentations. If you interrupt a peer for any reason (phone sounding off, leaving/entering the room, talking), you will receive a zero on your presentation grade.

Presentation Completion Requirement

Please note that failure to complete the Social media Report & Presentation, Final Research Paper & Presentation, and “Teach the Class” Facilitation presentation assignments results in an automatic F for the course, regardless of points accumulated. **All COMM 1010 students are required to deliver and record ONE speech in the Speaking Lab.**

Late Work Policy

I do not accept late work within the course. Any assigned work not submitted by the scheduled deadline will be considered late and receive a zero for failure to submit. Only exception to this rule is if there is a properly documented emergency and when it is communicated with me ahead of time.

Grade Disputes

Grades will be discussed only during the instructor’s office hours. Please do not ask grade questions during class time. If you have an issue with your grade, please wait 24 hours, but no later than 48 hours before submitting an email articulating your concern about your grade. Please include a reference to the work in question. This will give both the instructor and the student time to carefully review all of the information. After 48 hours, your grade will not be changed.

Drop/Withdrawal Policy

Withdrawing from a course is a formal procedure which **YOU** must initiate; the instructor cannot do it for you. You may withdraw from a class in either Admissions or Advising. If you stop attending or are unable to complete this class and you do not withdraw before the official drop date, you will receive a performance grade, usually a grade of “F.” Students sometimes drop a class when help is available that would enable them to continue. Please discuss your plans with the instructor if you feel the need to withdraw.

College-Level Reading, Writing, and Speaking Skills

College-level reading, writing, and speaking are expected. If your outlines or presentations do not meet college-standards, you will not receive credit for them. If you find you need help correcting grammatical and word choice errors, I strongly advise you to meet with a tutor in The Learning Center (M-216). I am happy to work with you to prepare and rehearse presentations to improve your fluency and articulation.

In addition to specific requirements for each paper assignment, please note the following guidelines in preparing all assignments:

- All written assignments must be typed.
- Format: Double-spaced, 12pt font, Times New Roman, 1” Margins, adhering to the APA Style Guide.
- All assignments must be submitted through Canvas **before** 11:59 pm the day they are due.
- Be sure to proof read your written work before submitting in order to correct any grammatical errors or spelling mistakes. **Please note that grammar and spelling are considered in grading. Knowing how to write properly is an essential part of communication.**

*****If these requirements are not met, points will be deducted from your paper grade.*****

Additional Resources for Students

I am happy to make reasonable accommodations when appropriate, provided that you notify me in timely fashion. All personal information will be kept in strict confidentiality. Below is a list of additional support services for students:

Disability Services SC 1104 972.338.1787	Financial Aid & Scholarships SC, One-Stop 972.780.3662	Career Services SC, 2nd Floor, Student Affairs Suite 972.338.1782
Library & Resources SC, 3rd Floor 972.338.1616	Academic Advising SC, 2nd Floor 972.338.1645	Counseling & Wellness SC 1085 972.338.1779
Student Connections and Support SC 2108 972.338.1326	Learning Commons SC, 2nd Floor https://www.untDallas.edu/learning/	Campus Police FH 135 972.780.3009

Speaking Center SC 2044 UNT-D-SpeakingCenter@untDallas.edu	Office of Student Affairs SC, 2nd Floor, Student Affairs Suite 972.338.1775	Veteran Success Center SC 2096 972.338.1786
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Key Dates

Please take note of the following key dates for the Fall 16-week session:

08/25/25 First Day of Class	09/01/25 Labor Day
08/29/25 Last Day to Add Classes	11/27/25 - 11/28/25 Fall Break
09/10/25 Census Day	10/06/25 – 10/11/25 Midterm Exams
09/10/25 Last Day to Drop without “W”	12/08/25 – 12/13/25 Final Exams
11/07/25 Last Day to Drop a Class with a “W”	12/15/25 Final Grades due from Faculty
11/21/25 Last Day to Drop all Classes with a “W”	09/21/25 Last Day to Apply for Graduation

Reminders

- Grades cannot be based on effort. Teachers cannot measure time or energy expended; only outcomes can be gauged. If you work hard at something and do not achieve the desired outcomes, a teacher cannot give you the grade you want or the higher grade because of your effort.
- Grades cannot be assigned because a student needs/wants a particular grade. If you desire the A, you will need to fulfill the conditions needed to earn an A.
- Grades are based on announced standards. Therefore, consideration of grade fairness must center on the application of those standards to student work, instead of comparisons to other student’s work.
- Generally, teachers are more experienced at assessing student work than the students themselves.
- Teachers, on average, are objective and are not out to “nail” their students. Most teachers want to give their students the highest grade possible and the benefit of the doubt.
- Students are entitled to emotional reactions to assessment of their work; however, these expressions should occur in private, NOT public.
- Any discussion of grades should be impartial, unemotional, and characterized by mutual respect, courtesy, and professionalism.

COMM 1010 – Fall 2025

I have read and understand the course expectations, division, and college policies and procedures, and the assignments and grades required for successful completion of this course outlined in this syllabus.

Signature:

Date:

Name Printed:

University Policies and Procedures

Students with Disabilities (ADA Compliance):

The University of North Texas at Dallas makes reasonable academic accommodations for students with disabilities. Students seeking accommodation must first register with the Disabilities Services Office (DSO) to verify their eligibility. If a disability is verified, the DSO will provide you with an accommodation letter to be delivered to faculty to begin a private discussion regarding your specific needs in a course. You may request accommodation at any time, however, DSO notices of accommodation should be provided as early as possible in the semester to avoid any delays in implementation. Note that a student must obtain a new letter of accommodation for every semester and must meet/communicate with each faculty member prior to implementation in each class. Students are strongly encouraged to deliver letters of accommodation during faculty office hours or by appointment. Faculty members have the authority to ask students to discuss such letters during their designated office hours to protect the privacy of the student. For additional information see the Disability Services Office website at <http://www.untDallas.edu/disability>. You may also contact them by phone at 972-338-1777; by email at UNTDisability@untDallas.edu on the first floor of the Student Center.

Canvas Instructure Accessibility Statement: optional if you do not use Canvas for the course

University of North Texas at Dallas is committed to ensuring that online and hybrid courses are usable by all students and faculty including those with disabilities. If you encounter any difficulties with technologies, please contact our ITSS Department. To better assist them, you would want to have the operating system, web browser and information on any assistive technology being used. The Canvas Instructure Accessibility Statement is provided at <https://www.canvaslms.com/accessibility>.

NOTE: Additional instructional technology tools, such as Turnitin, Respondus, Panopto, and publisher cartridge content (i.e. MyLab, Pearson, etc.) may NOT be fully ADA compliant. Please contact our Disability Office should you require additional assistance utilizing any of these tools.

Academic Integrity:

Academic integrity is a hallmark of higher education. You are expected to abide by the University's code of Academic Integrity policy. Any person suspected of academic dishonesty (i.e., cheating or plagiarism) will be handled in accordance with the University's policies and procedures. Refer to the UNT Dallas Academic Integrity Policy in the appropriate Catalog at <http://dallascatalog.unt.edu>.

Academic dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, cheating, plagiarizing, fabrication of information or citations, facilitating acts of dishonesty by others, having unauthorized possession of examinations, submitting work of another person or work previously used without informing the instructor, or tampering with the academic work of other students.

Web-based Plagiarism Detection: Please be aware in some courses, students may be required to submit written assignments to Turnitin, a web-based plagiarism detection service, or another method. If submitting to Turnitin, please remove your title page and other personal information.

Classroom etiquette:

Students are encouraged to contribute their perspectives and insights to class discussions. However, offensive & inappropriate language (swearing) and remarks offensive to others of nationalities, ethnic groups, sexual preferences, religious groups, genders, or other ascribed statuses will not be tolerated. Disruptions which violate the Code of Student's Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct will be referred to the Dean of Students as the instructor deems appropriate (UNT Policy 7.001 found at <https://untsystem.policytech.com/dotNet/documents/?docid=1278&public=true>).

Classroom Disruption:

Students are expected to always engage with the instructor and other students in this class in a respectful and civil manner to promote a classroom environment that is conducive to teaching and learning. Students who engage in disruptive behavior will be directed to leave the classroom. A student who is directed to leave class due to disruptive behavior is not permitted to return to class until the student meets with a representative from the Dean of Students Office. It is the student's responsibility to meet with the Dean of Students before class meets again and to provide the instructor confirmation of the meeting. A student who is directed to leave class will be assigned an unexcused absence for that class period and any other classes the student misses because of not meeting with the Dean of Students. The student is responsible for material missed during all absences, and the instructor is not responsible for providing missed material. In addition, the student will be assigned a failing grade for assignments, quizzes or examinations missed and will not be allowed to make up the work.

The Code of Student's Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct (UNT Policy 7.001 found at <https://untsystem.policytech.com/dotNet/documents/?docid=1278&public=true>) describes disruption as the obstructing or interfering with university functions or activity, including any behavior that interferes with students, faculty, or staff access to an appropriate educational environment. Examples of disruptive behavior that may result in a student being directed to leave the classroom include but are not limited to: failure to comply with reasonable directive of University officials, action or combination of actions that unreasonably interfere with, hinder, obstruct, or prevents the right of others to freely participate, threatening, assaulting, or causing harm to oneself or to another, uttering any words or performing any acts that cause physical injury, or threaten any individual, or interfere with any individual's rightful actions, and harassment. You are encouraged to read the Code of Student's Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct for more information related to behaviors that could be considered disruptive.

Course Evaluations:

Student evaluations of teaching effectiveness are a requirement for all organized classes at UNT Dallas. This short survey will be made available to you at the end of the semester via your campus email, providing you a chance to comment on how this class is taught. I (as the instructor) will not have access to the results of the evaluations until after final grades have been posted. I am very interested in the feedback I get from students, as I work to continually improve my teaching. I consider students' evaluations to be an important part of your participation in this class.

Sexual Harassment, Sexual Misconduct, Intimate Partner Violence and Stalking

UNT Dallas is committed to creating a safe learning environment for all members of our community, free from gender and sex-based discrimination, including sexual harassment, domestic and dating violence, sexual assault, and stalking, in accordance with Title IX, Texas laws and University Policies. Please note that all employees are mandated reporters and must report all instances of sexual misconduct, dating violence, sexual assault, domestic violence and stalking to the Title IX Coordinator. If you or someone you know has experienced any form of sex or gender-based discrimination or violence and wish to speak to the Title IX Coordinator, you can email them at titleix@untDallas.edu or file a report here.

Pregnancy, Pregnancy Related Conditions and Parenting Modifications Under Title IX

UNT Dallas is committed to compliance with Title IX, and to supporting the academic success of pregnant and parenting students and students with pregnancy related conditions. If you are a pregnant, have pregnant related conditions or a parenting student (child under one-year needs documented medical care) who wishes to request reasonable related modifications from the University under Title IX, please email the Title IX Coordinator at titleix@untdallas.edu. The Title IX Coordinator will work with your professors and academic unit to provide reasonable modifications needed to be supportive of your education while pregnant or as a parent under Title IX.

Bad Weather Policy:

Campus facilities will close, and operations will be suspended when adverse weather and/or safety hazards exist on the UNTD campus or if travel to the campus is deemed dangerous as the result of ice, sleet or snow. In the event of a campus closure, the Marketing and Communication Department will report closure information to all appropriate major media by 7 a.m. That department will also update the UNTD website, Facebook and Twitter with closing information as soon as it is possible. For more information, please refer to <http://www.untdallas.edu/police/resources/notifications>.

Technology Assistance: To successfully access the materials in Canvas, UNT Dallas advises that your computer be equipped with the minimum system requirements listed on the first page of the syllabus.

If you have trouble accessing or using components of the course, try using Google Chrome browser. If you still experience technical difficulties, first, notify your instructor.

If the problem is still not resolved, call Distance Learning at the phone number listed on the first page of the syllabus. Also, no matter what browser you use, always enable pop-ups.

For more information see:

- UNT Dallas Canvas Technical Requirements: <https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10721>
- Canvas Instructure Support & Unsupported Operating Systems: <https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10720>